

Relay Mails Using Gmail on RHEL6.1

This article explains the use of Postfix as a mail transfer agent to relay mails using Gmail.

In this article, let's explore how to configure RHEL 6.1 [x86] to relay emails using Gmail. In order to do so, we need to configure Postfix in RHEL 6.1. Postfix is a free and open source mail transfer agent [MTA] that routes and delivers emails. It's an alternative to Sendmail, which, to date, is the most widely used MTA that routes and delivers emails. It supports various mail transfer and delivery methods, which includes SMTP (Simple Mail Transfer Protocol).

Prerequisites

The settings given below are configured.

1. The operating system, host name and IP address used are RHEL 6.1, PILOTVM01.linuxrocks.org and 192.168.1.15, respectively.
2. The `/etc/hosts` configuration file should look like what's shown below:

```
#cat /etc/hosts
```

```
127.0.0.1    localhost localhost.localdomain localhost4
localhost4.localdomain4
::1         localhost localhost.localdomain localhost6
localhost6.localdomain6
192.168.1.15    PILOTVM01      PILOTVM01.
linuxrocks.org
```

3. To set the IP address, type:
[GUI – System -> Preferences -> Network Connection];
4. Now, turn 'OFF' the firewall:
[GUI – System -> Administration -> Firewall].
If you want to stop the firewall using command, we can run:

```
service iptables stop
chkconfig iptables off
```

5. Next, disable SELinux.
6. Now change the system's date and time [optional].
To change date and time go to System -> Administration -> Date & Time and modify the value.

Postfix configuration on RHEL 6.1 x86

Before we start with the configuration, here are some points to consider. For office users, Internet connectivity to Postfix Server is a must. In case of limited Internet connectivity as part of organisational policy, at least Gmail must be accessible.

For home users, Internet connectivity to Postfix Server should not be an issue.

Since, in my environment, I have a separate colour coded cable for free Internet, I just needed to configure the IP address mode to be dynamic so as to receive the IP address automatically. In my case, the IP address received is 192.168.1.15

So, the network configuration depends upon the environment in which you are configuring Postfix Server.

Verify if the Postfix package is already installed, as follows:

```
#rpm -qa | grep postfix*
postfix-2.6.6-2.1.el6_0.i686
```

As observed, the package is already installed.

If not installed, please install the package from the RHEL 6.1 DVD with the following command:

```
#rpm --ivh --aid --force postfix-2.6.6-2.1.el6_0.i686.rpm
```

In case of package dependencies, keep appending the dependent package name with the above command till all dependencies are resolved and Postfix is installed.

Once the package is installed, open the primary configuration file of Postfix with the Vi Editor:

```
#vi /etc/postfix/main.cf
```

Now add the following lines at the end of the configuration file [precisely after Line 676]:

```
#EDITED BY ARINDAM MITRA
smtp_sasl_security_options = noanonymous
#sasl [Simple Authentication and Secure Layer]
#option, no anonymous login.
relayhost = smtp.gmail.com:587
#Setting Gmail as relay
smtp_use_tls = yes
#Use TLS [Transport Layer Security]
smtp_tls_CAfile = /etc/postfix/cacert.pem
#Trusted Server Certificate while verifying
smtp_sasl_auth_enable = yes
#Use of sasl [Simple Authentication and Secure Layer]

#while authenticating to foreign SMTP Server, in our
```